

Digital Public Services Accessibility Bill, 2026 (Sample Legislative Document)

Document Type: Draft Government Bill

Jurisdiction: Republic of India

Section 1: Short Title and Commencement

- This Act shall be called the Digital Public Services Accessibility Act, 2026.
- It shall come into force on a date notified by the Central Government in the Official Gazette.

Section 2: Definitions

- "Digital Service" means any service provided through websites, mobile applications, or electronic platforms operated by government authorities.
- "Citizen" means any individual who is a resident of India.
- "Accessible Technology" refers to systems designed to be usable by persons with disabilities including visual, hearing, cognitive, and motor impairments.
- "Public Authority" includes ministries, departments, state governments, local authorities, and government-funded institutions.

Section 3: Mandatory Accessibility Standards

- Every public authority shall ensure that all digital services comply with accessibility standards issued by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology.
- The standards shall include screen reader compatibility, multilingual support, text-to-speech features, and mobile device compatibility.
- All newly launched digital platforms must comply with the standards within 12 months of the enactment of this Act.

Section 4: Accessibility Compliance Audit

- Public authorities must conduct an accessibility audit of their digital services once every two years.
- The audit must be conducted by certified accessibility auditors approved by the government.
- The audit report shall be made publicly available.

Section 5: Citizen Complaint Mechanism

- Citizens may submit complaints regarding inaccessible digital services through an online grievance portal.
- Public authorities must respond within 30 days of receiving the complaint.
- Failure to address valid complaints may result in administrative penalties.

Section 6: Penalties

- Any public authority failing to comply with the accessibility requirements may be subject to a penalty not exceeding ₹10,00,000.

- Repeated violations may result in disciplinary action against responsible officials.

Section 7: Implementation Authority

- The Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) shall monitor compliance, issue guidelines and standards, and conduct awareness programs.

Section 8: Power to Make Rules

- The Central Government may make rules for carrying out the provisions of this Act.